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How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

Tech Careers

Connections For Neophytes

**Chisel a career
that makes and
uses the
connections
that count!**

Samir Makwana

India is rapidly developing into a tech-hungry country. Sales of Desktops and laptops combined crossed 5.43 million units in the fiscal year 2005-06. The number of Internet subscribers rose from 3.12 million in March 2005 to 4.12 million in March 2006. This is the connected age, and these figures, from the Annual Review report by MAIT-IMRB (Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology-Indian Market Research Bureau); give us a comprehensive picture of how much connectivity is now required!

Connectivity is provided by networks. The requirement for those who will connect computers through networks will soon increase. These people are identified as networking professionals.

"Networking professionals are individuals capable of planning a wired and wireless infrastructure to support network connectivity by installing, configuring, and troubleshooting network devices for Internet and server connectivity," says Ranajoy Punja, Vice President, Business Development - Advance Technologies, Cisco Systems, India and SAARC.

Stepping Stones

A keen interest in, and knowledge of, computer hardware are the foundations for procuring entry into the networking field. "Clarity in the basics of computers, and a good understand-

ing of the hardware and software of computer systems are the primary requirements to begin with," says J Sheshadri, CTO, Emerson Network Power India Ltd.

Along with the sharing of data over the network, arises the issue of security—security of data over the network is a serious concern. The field of networks and security are dynamic: with rapid developments happening in various areas of networking, existing technologies are challenged. By the time one gets well-versed with a particular network technology, along comes another.

Those willing to make the best of their drive can complete formal education and earn a college degree. The precise names of the degree programs vary from institute to institute, and most colleges do not offer a special degree program focusing solely on networking. A suitable graduate or master's degree program for networking

Illustration Chaitanya Surpur
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